

Five Publish-Ready Posts

Book insight • Industry observation • Contrarian opinion • Personal story • Lesson from class
Final selected variations — June 2026

AT A GLANCE

What Each Post Represents

#	Topic	Format	What it represents in the content mix
01	Holes by Louis Sachar	Data-driven	The reflective reader: trust and reciprocity as systems insight, not sentiment. Signals depth beyond business content.
02	India's IT sector in 2026	Data-driven	The industry analyst: a sharp, evidence-backed read on a live structural shift. Core credibility post for recruiters.
03	Buying the dip on “failing” companies	Data-driven	The independent thinker: a contrarian investing position argued with filters, not bravado. Speaks to PE/VC ambitions.
04	Lessons from travel	Story-driven	The human being: ten countries distilled into self-aware takeaways. Balances the analytical posts and invites conversation.
05	Calculus for managers	Data-driven	The MBA in progress: classroom theory translated into pricing, CLV and budget decisions. Shows applied learning in real time.

Posting note: alternate analytical and story posts rather than publishing in sequence. Post 04 carries no hashtags by design; the other four close with 3–4.

01

IDEA 01 • BOOK INSIGHT • DATA-DRIVEN

Holes by Louis Sachar: What a Toxic System Can't Ration

Represents: reflective reader & systems thinker • ~310 words • Hook: setup-and-subversion • Hashtags: yes

A camp designed to break boys ends up proving the opposite of its own philosophy.

That's the quiet genius of Louis Sachar's Holes.

Camp Green Lake runs on a simple operating model: isolate, exhaust, divide. Every boy digs his own hole. Every man for himself. The system is engineered so nobody has spare energy for anyone else.

And inside that system, the only two people who actually escape it are the two who break its core rule.

Stanley Yelnats teaches Zero to read. Zero, in return, digs part of Stanley's hole, shares what he knows, and eventually saves his life on the mountain. Their trade starts as a transaction and becomes something the camp has no defence against: loyalty.

Three things this gets right about toxic systems, whether it's a desert camp or a cutthroat workplace:

1. **Scarcity is a control mechanism:** When everyone is depleted, cooperation looks irrational. That's by design, not accident.
2. **Reciprocity compounds:** One small exchange (reading lessons for digging help) created a bond no incentive structure at the camp could replicate or destroy.
3. **Trust is asymmetric risk:** Stanley risked ridicule. Zero risked dependence. Both bets paid off precisely because the environment made them rare.

Fair pushback: it's a children's novel, and fiction proves nothing. True. But Google's Project Aristotle reached the same conclusion after studying hundreds of its own teams: psychological safety, not individual talent, was the strongest predictor of team effectiveness. The mechanism Sachar wrote in 1998 is the one researchers measured two decades later.

The reframe: Camp Green Lake didn't fail to break Stanley and Zero. It accidentally revealed that connection is the one resource a toxic system can't ration.

Which environment in your career taught you more about trust, the supportive one or the brutal one?

#Leadership #Trust #BookLessons #Teamwork

SUGGESTED FIRST COMMENT

"Bonus detail: Stanley and Zero's families were linked generations back — the friendship literally broke a curse older than both of them."

02

IDEA 02 • INDUSTRY OBSERVATION • DATA-DRIVEN

India's IT Sector in 2026: The Formula That Quietly Died

Represents: analytical, recruiting-aware industry voice • ~360 words • Hook: binary contrast • Hashtags: yes

For three decades, Indian IT had one growth formula: more revenue = more people. In 2026, that formula quietly died.

In FY26, the combined headcount of India's five largest IT firms fell by roughly 6,981, reversing a net addition of over 12,700 the previous year. The decline was led by TCS, which cut more than 23,000 jobs after a mid-2025 rationalisation.

Small numbers against a 5+ million workforce. Massive signal.

Because the slowdown isn't just cyclical. Yes, global uncertainty, tariffs and cautious client spending are squeezing demand, and Infosys guided for just flat to 3% revenue growth for FY26. But underneath the cycle sits a structural shift: firms are deliberately trying to break the link between revenue growth and workforce size, with AI and automation at the centre of that effort.

The evidence is in campus hiring. TCS released about 25,000 campus offers this year, down from 40,000+ a few years ago. Companies are openly shifting from volume-based recruitment to AI-led, skill-specific hiring, and paying significantly more for niche talent.

So what's the way forward? Three honest bets:

1. **Pyramid inverts:** Fewer freshers, more specialists. The “bench” model that built Bangalore is uneconomical when AI does the bottom layer's work.
2. **AI revenue must scale fast:** Nasscom expects the sector to touch \$315 billion in FY26, with AI revenues of only \$10–12 billion — too small to offset weakness in traditional application development and maintenance. Closing that gap is the whole game.
3. **Domestic demand matters more:** Export dependence on a slowing US is the core vulnerability. India's own digitisation is the underpriced hedge.

Fair pushback: every IT “crisis” since 2008 ended in recovery. Probably true again. But recovery this time means the sector earns more while employing proportionally fewer people — which changes everything for the lakhs of engineers India graduates annually.

The reframe: Indian IT isn't declining. Indian IT employment-as-we-knew-it is.

If you were advising a 2026 engineering fresher, would you still point them at IT services?

#IndianIT #TechCareers #AI #FutureOfWork

SUGGESTED FIRST COMMENT

Add the \$315B Nasscom projection up top to pre-empt “doom and gloom” replies.

03

IDEA 03 • CONTRARIAN OPINION • DATA-DRIVEN

Buying the Dip on “Failing” Companies: Underwriting Overreaction

Represents: independent investing judgment (PE/VC signal) • ~390 words • Hook: contrarian claim • Hashtags: yes

The best entry price on a great company is usually printed on its worst headline day.

Unpopular take: buying deeply hated stocks — not just dipped, but written-off — is a legitimate strategy, and the discomfort you feel doing it is precisely why it pays.

The logic is simple. Markets don't price companies; they price narratives about companies. When pessimism peaks, the narrative (“this business is dead”) gets priced as certainty, even when the underlying risk is merely probable.

The classic example: Meta in late 2022. The narrative was that the metaverse pivot had broken the company, and the stock fell below \$90 — down roughly 75% from its peak. The business underneath — the ad engine, three billion users, enormous cash flow — was bruised, not broken. Within two years the stock had risen more than fivefold from that low.

Same pattern elsewhere: Adani group stocks shed over \$100 billion in market value in the weeks after the Hindenburg report, then recovered a large part of it as the worst-case scenario failed to materialise. Airlines post-COVID followed the script too.

But here's the framework that separates this from gambling. Before buying maximum pessimism, ask:

1. **Income statement or balance sheet?** Earnings problems heal. Solvency problems kill. Never catch a company that can't service its debt.
2. **Is the moat intact?** Meta's users never left. A truly failing company loses customers, not just margin.
3. **Pessimism about business or price?** A stock down 70% can still be expensive if the business halved.
4. **Can you survive being early?** Maximum pessimism can get more maximal. Position size is the strategy.

Fair pushback: for every Meta there's a Yes Bank — shareholders who bought that “dip” saw their capital nearly wiped out and never recovered. Correct. Which is why this is a portfolio strategy with strict filters, not a single lottery ticket. You're underwriting overreaction, not failure.

The reframe: “buy the dip” isn't about courage. It's about doing balance-sheet homework when everyone else is doing vibes.

What's a written-off company you think the market has fundamentally misread right now?

#Investing #ContrarianInvesting #ValueInvesting #Markets

SUGGESTED FIRST COMMENT

“To be clear — this works on hated-but-solvent companies, not actually-dying ones. The balance sheet is the dividing line.”

04

IDEA 04 • PERSONAL STORY • STORY-DRIVEN

Lessons From Travel: Ten Countries, One Recalibration

Represents: human, globally curious side of the profile • ~240 words • Hook: perspective shift • Hashtags: none (story post)

Ten countries taught me less about the world and more about my own defaults.

Australia, USA, Maldives, Kenya, Italy, Thailand, UK, Switzerland, Japan. Different continents, currencies, and ideas of what “on time” means.

One morning in Kenya, our safari guide read the landscape like a spreadsheet — tracks, wind, birdsong — and found in minutes what we'd have missed in hours. A week's worth of my planning, outperformed by someone fluent in his environment.

Months later, standing in a silent, spotless Tokyo metro, the same thought returned from the opposite direction: every place I'd mentally filed as “chaotic” or “overly rigid” was actually optimised — just for something I hadn't thought to value.

What travel actually compounds into:

1. **Defaults are local:** How you queue, negotiate, tip, and disagree are settings, not truths. Seeing yours from outside is the whole point.
2. **Service is a cultural thesis:** Japanese hospitality, American friendliness, Italian indifference-until-you're-family — each is a different answer to “what do customers deserve?”
3. **Constraint breeds character:** The Maldives builds luxury on scarcity. Kenya builds ingenuity on it. Switzerland builds precision on abundance. Inputs don't determine outputs.
4. **You pack lighter each trip:** In luggage, and in assumptions.

The destinations were the excuse. The recalibration was the product.

Which place rewired an assumption you didn't know you had?

SUGGESTED FIRST COMMENT

Share one photo from the Kenya or Japan moment — a single image will lift this post's reach significantly.

05

IDEA 05 • LESSON FROM CLASS • DATA-DRIVEN

Calculus for Managers: The Math You Use Without Knowing It

Represents: MBA-in-progress, applied-quant credibility • ~360 words • Hook: setup-and-subversion • Hashtags: yes

Most managers think they left calculus behind in school. They actually use it every day — just badly, and without knowing it.

This clicked for me in an MBA quant class at IIM Ahmedabad covering derivatives and integration in business decisions.

Strip the notation away and the two ideas are this:

A derivative answers: “If I change one thing slightly, what happens?” That’s marginal thinking. The cost of one more unit. The revenue from one more customer. The conversion lift from one more rupee of ad spend.

An integral answers: “What does it all add up to?” Total cost across a production run. Lifetime value accumulated over a customer relationship. Total demand under a price curve.

Why this matters in practice:

1. **Pricing is a derivative problem:** Profit is maximised where marginal revenue equals marginal cost — not where total revenue is highest. Companies chasing topline routinely price past the optimum.
2. **Marketing budgets ignore diminishing returns:** The first lakh of ad spend and the tenth don’t perform alike. The derivative of returns-to-spend is the only number that tells you when to stop.
3. **CLV is literally an integral:** Customer lifetime value is accumulated margin over time, discounted. Every SaaS dashboard is doing calculus and calling it a metric.
4. **Averages lie, margins don’t:** “Average cost per unit” hides whether your next unit is cheap or ruinous. Decisions happen at the margin, always.

Fair pushback: managers have Excel; nobody solves equations by hand. True — but Excel computes, it doesn’t decide. Knowing whether a question is a marginal question or a cumulative question is the actual skill, and that’s conceptual, not computational.

The reframe: calculus was never about solving for x . It was a language for change and accumulation — which is a decent two-word summary of what managers manage.

What’s a concept from your “useless” college courses that turned out to be quietly load-bearing at work?

#MBA #DecisionMaking #Pricing #ManagementEducation

SUGGESTED FIRST COMMENT

Share the actual classroom pricing example with numbers — concrete math will outperform the abstract version in replies.